

TOPIC 3: VERBS, TENSES, CONCORD, ACTIVE & PASSIVE VOICE

1. Tenses

Present (simple, continuous, perfect), Past (simple, continuous, perfect), Future (will, going to, present continuous for future). Use the correct form according to time and aspect.

2. Concord (Subject–Verb Agreement)

Singular subjects take singular verbs; plural subjects take plural verbs. Watch out for collective nouns, indefinite pronouns, and phrases between subject and verb.

Example: The boy runs. The boys run. Either of the answers is correct.

3. Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

Transitive: take a direct object (She wrote a letter). Intransitive: no object (He slept). Some verbs can be both depending on use.

4. Active and Passive Voice

Active: subject does the action (The chef cooked the meal). Passive: subject receives the action (The meal was cooked by the chef). Form passive with be + past participle. Use passive when the doer is unknown or less important.

5. Summary

Correct tense, concord and voice make writing and speech accurate. Practise changing sentences between active and passive and checking subject–verb agreement.

End of Topic 3